ajo

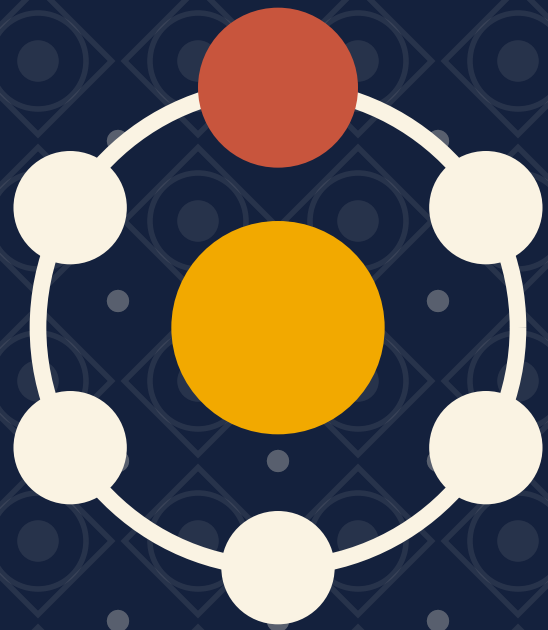
Your circle, your capital.

BRAND IDENTITY PACKAGE

Mastery Project | Brand Strategy, Visual Identity & Applications

Designed by OnyeJekwe Philip Emeka (Don-Philip)

A digital savings-circle platform for West Africa



STEP 1 | SELECT YOUR ORGANIZATION

Meet Ajo

Ajo is a mobile savings-circle platform for traders, artisans, drivers and salaried workers in Nigeria and Ghana. It takes the rotating savings tradition people already trust - ajo and esusu in Yoruba, isusu in Igbo, susu in Ghana - and makes it transparent, automated and safe.

The name comes from the Yoruba word for a shared contribution. It is short, easy to say in any language of the region, and carries its meaning with it.

ORGANIZATION SNAPSHOT

Type	Fintech start-up (fictional concept)
Market	Nigeria and Ghana, expanding across West Africa
Offer	Group savings circles, automatic contributions, scheduled payouts
Users	Market traders, artisans, gig and salaried workers
Business model	Small service fee on each payout; premium circles for businesses



STEP 2 | CONDUCT RESEARCH

Research & Insights

Cultural context

Rotating savings groups are among the most familiar ways to save in West Africa. Their strength is trust between people who know each other. Their weakness is that everything depends on one organizer and a notebook.

Competitor audit

Savings and investment apps (for example PiggyVest and Cowrywise), microfinance banks and informal cooperatives. Apps lean on cool blues and purples and individual goals; cooperatives feel warm but have no transparency or technology.

Audience insight

People are not short of discipline; they are short of safe places and flexible tools. They want proof the money is safe, to see who has paid, and a payout date they can plan a business or school fee around.

THE GAP

Fintech is efficient but impersonal. Tradition is warm but fragile. Ajo can own the space between: the warmth of a trusted circle with the reliability of technology.

STEP 3 | DEFINE BRAND STRATEGY

Positioning & Audience

POSITIONING STATEMENT

For hard-working people who save with friends, family and colleagues, Ajo is the savings circle platform that keeps every contribution visible and every payout on time, because your community is your strongest bank.

PRIMARY AUDIENCE

Adaeze, 34, runs a fabric stall in Lagos. She saves in two ajo groups, tracks payments in a notebook, and has been let down once by an organizer who disappeared. She wants safety without losing the community.

BRAND PERSONALITY

Warm
speaks like a trusted friend

Dependable
clear, never vague about money

Communal
we over I, always

Proud
confidently African, not generic

BRAND MISSION

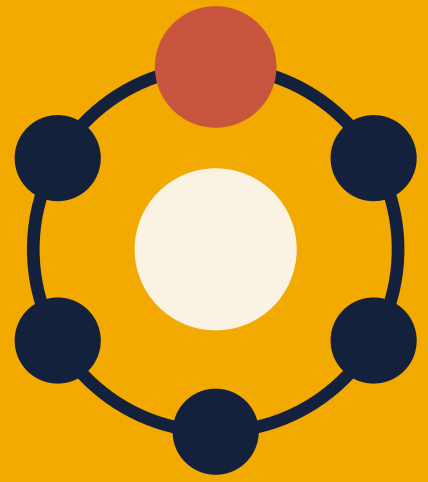
Brand Mission

To make saving together simple, transparent and safe, so that everyday people can fund the things that matter: a shop, school fees, a home.

Vision: a West Africa where no one has to save alone, and no contribution is ever lost to chance.

Brand Promise

Every naira counted. Every turn honoured.



Visible

Every member sees every contribution, in real time.

On time

Payouts arrive on the agreed day, automatically.

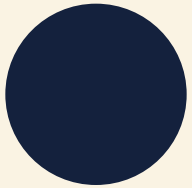
Protected

Funds are held safely, never in one person's hands.

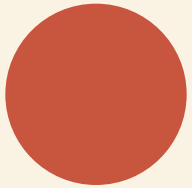
Brand Essence

Together, we rise.

The essence is the single idea behind everything Ajo does: progress is shared, and the circle makes each person stronger. Every design decision from the ring of dots to the warm marigold comes back to it.



Community



Transparency



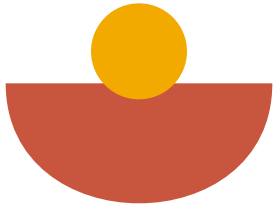
Reliability



Dignity

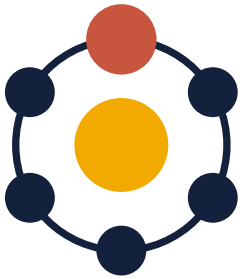
STEP 4 | EXPLORE VISUAL DIRECTIONS

Exploration & Refinement



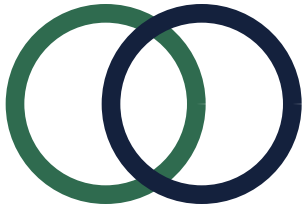
A The Pot

A calabash holding a coin. Familiar, but reads as food or generic finance.



B The Ring

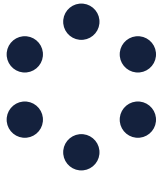
Members in a circle around the shared pot. Direct picture of an ajo group.



C The Knot

Interlocking rings for trust. Abstract, easily confused with other fintech marks.

REFINEMENT OF DIRECTION B



v1

Six equal dots. Too uniform, no story.



v2

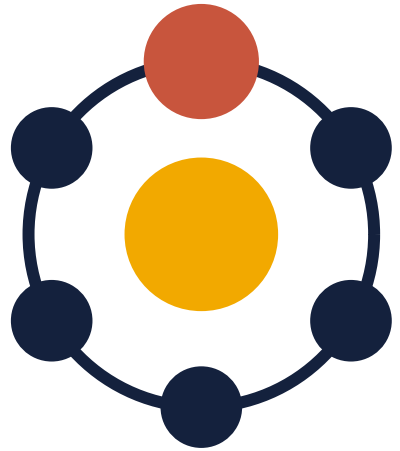
Top dot enlarged and in terracotta: it marks whose turn it is to receive.



v3

Marigold coin in the centre and a thin ring joining the circle. Final.

Logo & Logotype



ajo

Primary logo: symbol + logotype

The symbol

Six members around a shared coin. The terracotta dot is the member whose turn it is to receive, so the logo always shows movement and fairness.

The logotype

Lowercase serif letters feel friendly and grounded. The rounded forms echo the circle of the symbol, and the word works as a signature on its own.

Clear space and size

Keep clear space equal to the height of the centre coin on all sides. Minimum size: 24 px (screen), 10 mm (print) for the symbol.

ALTERNATE LOCKUPS

Alternate Lockups



Horizontal





Stacked with tagline



Reversed on indigo



Symbol only / app icon



Logotype only



One colour on marigold

Typography

DISPLAY: DEJAVU SERIF BOLD

Aa

Headlines, logotype, key numbers

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

Why: soft, sturdy serifs feel established and trustworthy, like a signed agreement, while staying warm.

Hierarchy

Headline 28 pt

Subheading 14 pt bold | Body 11 pt regular

BODY: CARLITO (REGULAR / BOLD)

Aa

Interface, captions, long copy

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

Why: open, highly legible at small sizes and on low-end phones, which matters for our audience.

Rules

Headlines in sentence case. Body at 1.4 line height. Never set body copy in the display face.

COLOR PALETTE

Color Palette

Adire Indigo
#14213D

R 20 G 33 B 61

Trust, depth, primary text and backgrounds

Marigold
#F2A900

R 242 G 169 B 0

Prosperity, energy, the coin

Terracotta
#C8553D

R 200 G 85 B 61

Warmth, people, the active turn

Kola Green
#2F6B4F

R 47 G 107 B 79

Growth, success states, confirmation

Cream
#FAF3E3

R 250 G 243 B 227

Main light background

Sand
#E6DABF

R 230 G 218 B 191

Dividers, secondary surfaces

Usage ratio: 50% Cream/Sand | 30% Indigo | 15% Marigold | 5% Terracotta and Green

Custom Iconography



Save



Circle



Protected



Mobile



Grow



Payout day

ICON RULES

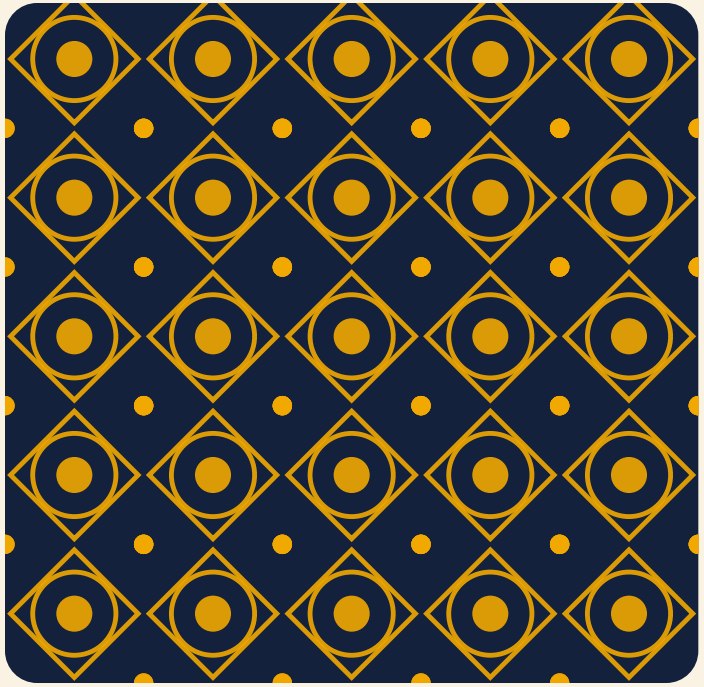
Rounded line style, 4.5 pt stroke on a 64 px grid

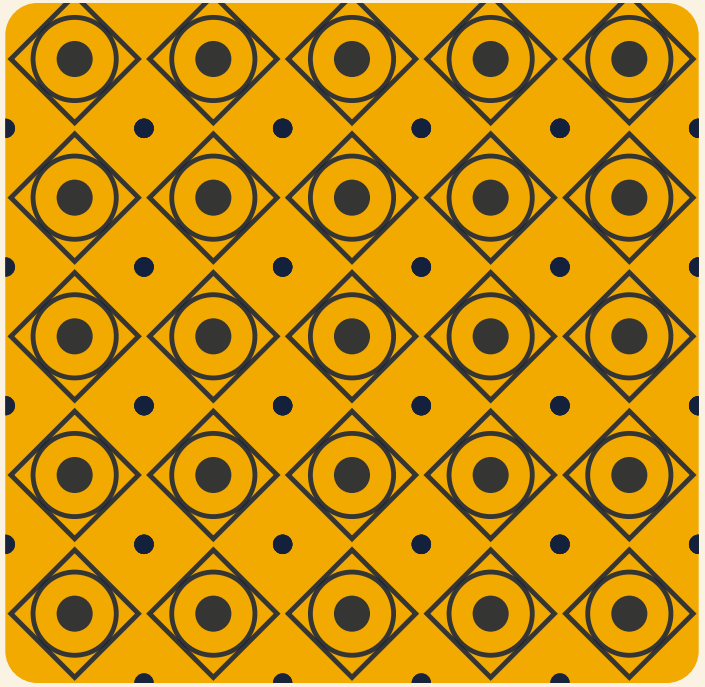
Indigo outline with one terracotta accent per icon

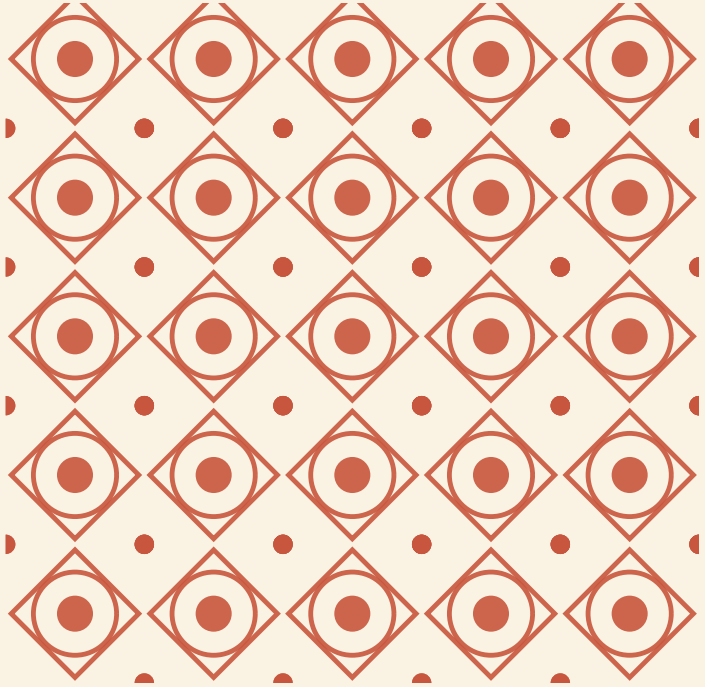
Round caps and joins echo the circle symbol

Reversed version: cream outline, marigold accent

Brand Pattern: "Ring Cloth"







Inspired by West African adire and kente cloth, the pattern repeats the symbol's ideas: a circle with a centre point, linked by a diamond lattice. Use it as a background texture on packaging, social posts, cards and signage, at low contrast behind text.

STEP 6 | APPLY ACROSS TOUCHPOINTS

Brand Applications: Stationery



Business cards (front and back), letterhead and envelope

Brand Applications: Signage





Storefront fascia and agent point totem sign

Brand Applications: Merchandise



Tote bag



T-shirt (agent uniform)



Mug

Typography-led Collateral

Your savings, in full view.

See every contribution, live.

12 members. 12 payouts. 0 surprises.

ajo.africa

Start a circle with people you trust.

Download Ajo

Saving alone is hard. Saving together is a plan.

#TogetherWeRise

POSTER

Whose turn is it this month?

Start your circle at ajo.africa

SUMMARY

From Strategy to Design

Warm and communal	Circle of dots, rounded serif, terracotta and marigold
Dependable and clear	Indigo base, strong contrast, simple icon set, readable body type
Proudly African	Adire-inspired Ring Cloth pattern, West African naming and colour story
Together, we rise	Every touchpoint shows a group, a circle or a shared coin

ajo